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Geo-political implications means :-

- How global power is shifting ?-
- How readjustments in Foreign Policy ?.

• World Order / Geo-politics before ~~World~~ Ukraine War?

- After the end of Cold War World witnessed Unipolar world, when there is a Single Super-power states will prefer "Band Wagoning".

Much before Ukraine war World Order started changing.

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Moving away from the state of Unipolarity. Instead of Bipolarity, post-Cold War Unipolar world has given rise to Multi-polarity. Countries like - China, India, Russia, E.U. started emerging.

The decline of U.S. Hegemony started with September 11 / 2001, continued further when U.S.A engaged itself in Iraq war.

Further blow to U.S. Hegemony came with "Sub-Prime lending Crisis / Global Financial Crisis (2007-08)", symbolising the emergence of BRICS.

The present War in Ukraine is the continuation of the trend. German Chancellor Olaf Scholz in his recent Article published in "Foreign Affairs" title - The Global Zietenwende ! How to avoid New Cold war in a Multipolar Era,

Zietenwende
↓
A change in the order.

mentions about the following Geo-political consequences:-

- i) Exit of Globalisation.
- ii) Breakdown of Multilateralism. (Weakening of Liberal World Order)
- iii) The Revival of Imperialist Politics / Revanchism
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forcibly acquiring someone's land.
territorial order
- iv) It changes the Post II.W.War in Europe.
- v) It also marks the rise of China.

However, there has not been revival of U.S. Hegemony in some context. NATO w/c has been seen as Brain Dead, has got revived. Similarly, U.S. has also made some gain for examples - Trans Atlantic Partnership has got strengthened. Russia has become isolated in Europe.

The Future of Europe appears uncertain. The Greatest challenge w/c Europe is going to face will be Refugee Crisis.

Globally, Refugee Crisis, Energy Crisis, Crisis of Food Security may give rise to Inter-State and Intra-State Challenges.

We can say that, Covid had adversely impacted Peace and stability, World was on the path of Recovery, but Ukraine Crisis has rolled back the situation.

Similarly, Rudolf Adam, former Vice-President of Germany's Federal Intelligence Service, wrote in GIIS Reports (Global Intelligence Service Report):-

- i) War in Ukraine has brought a Fundamental Shift in Geo-Political Distribution of Power.
- ii) The main beneficiaries of Russia's War have been China, India, Turkey, Iran & North Korea.
 - iii) a) China and India were quick to take the advantage of Cheap Russian Oil.
 - b) China gained diplomatically though India couldn't gain diplomatically.
 - c) China is now better placed in Russia's Far East.
 - d) Since, Russia is involved in Ukraine, it allows Turkey to strengthen its position in Syria.
 - e) Iran and N. Korea have ensured that Russia supports them at Critical junctures.
- iii) Though the Political Influence of Arab World has increased in short-term but in long terms they will lose b/c of the Renaissance of Nuclear Power.
- iv) Presently the world is divided into the 3 Groups (Return of Cold War type situations)

3 Groups:-

 - a) Western Liberal Democracy.
 - b) Russia, Belarus, Iran, Syria, Venezuela, China, N. Korea. (**Authoritarian Block**)
 - c) Developing Countries (South Asia, Arab World, South America).

v) International Institutions like - U.N. , or Organisation for Security & Co-operation in Europe are paralysed.

Regional Organisations are expected to gain importance.

* Scott Newman :-

↳ His Article :- "The Ripple effect of Russia's War"

- i) Russia's invasion of Ukraine sparked the largest conflict in Europe since W.W.II.
- ii) It has led to Geo-Political Realignment.
- iv) It has caused Economic Hardships even for the Regions located far from the Epicentre of Fighting.
- v) It has touched off Refugee Crisis.
- vi) It has led to the process of expansion of NATO with Finland and Sweden leaving the policy of Neutrality followed since long.
- vii) It has created Crisis of Food Security particularly in African and Middle East Countries.
- viii) It has revived the Arms industry.
- ix) It has created more distancing b/w Turkey & West.
 - a) Turkey has thrown up objections against allowing Sweden and Finland in alliance.
 - b) Turkey - Russia relations improved. Turkey has brokered deal with Russia to allow Ukrainian Grains to pass through Black Sea Ports. Thus, improved Turkey's diplomatic Profile.

* Disintegration of U.S.S.R !—

Q) Do you think that Gorbachev was responsible for disintegration of USSR ?

Conventional View!—

Gorbachev was responsible for disintegration. This argument is gets more strength b/c Gorbachev was given "Nobel Peace Prize".

Which policies of Gorbachev were seen responsible?

- i) Glasnost !— Openness. It means democratic reforms.
- ii) Perestroika !— It is Economic Re-structuring. It means shift from Communism to Market Economy.
- iii) Sinatra Doctrine !— It replaced Brezhnev doctrine.

These doctrines represents USSR's foreign policy w.r.t East European States.

- Brezhnev Doctrine was maintaining tight control over govt. in Eastern Europe.
- Sinatra Doctrine was based on famous song of Frank Sinatra.

Why Soviet gave Relaxation in neighbourhoods?

- B/c it was no more affordable to sustain the support these Govts.

Once USSR loosened the strings, Communism started Collapsing like - House of Cards.

Why? -

- B/c the Communist Govt. were not based on the support of the people but they were imposed on them by all sides.

Whether Gorbachev wanted Collapse of USSR?

- Gorbachev didn't introduced Reforms with the objective to weaken the Empire but to strengthen the Empire. U.S.S.R was already in the state of Decay.

Reason behind Decay! -

- The structural weakness of Russia has been Economic.

a) It has been Russian Compulsion to go for planned

Economy.

b) Planned Economy is a supply side Economy, w/c brings Good Returns at the initial level of development. E.g! - Private Sector will not go for setting up basic industries.

However, later on its weaknesses starts emerging.

In order to gain Economic advantage, technological innovation is required. State alone can't provide such amount of Resources w/c is required for innovation.

6

• The Economic weakness more problematic when! —

- i) Huge State structure exist and there is a corruption.
- ii) When Economically weak State has to take the burden of other States to maintain its image.

U.S. followed the policy of beggar Thy Enemy towards Russia. —

- a) Keep Russia engaged in Arms Race.
- b) In War (like- War of Attrition)
- c) Keeping the oil prices low.

Alongwith above structural weaknesses during this time Russia suffered —

- a) Chernobyl Nuclear Disaster.
- b) Earthquake

B/c of various Reasons, it suffered from Famine.

There was huge dissatisfaction among people with the way Govt. dealt with Crisis.

Thus, Russia was already suffering from Pressure Cooker Syndrome. When Govt. introduced Political Reform gave opportunity to the people to speak, Resentment became Vocal. Gradually, Republics started coming out of the Union w/c was finally dissolved in December 1991 (formed in 1922).

Thus, Combination of Factors played the role, if we look at history of Russia there is a SAGA of Expansion & Contraction.

Thus, it would be wrong to blame Gorbachev for Geo-Political Disasters.

Q) When Communism Collapsed in USSR, why it didn't Collapse in China?

China had already started moving towards liberalization.
Liberalization in both sense of the terms!—

a) Economic Liberalization

b) Political " " !—

↳ the time when Anti-Communist movement were going on in Eastern Europe, similar protest also started in China. E.g:- Tiananmen.

China took Fast and Effective measures, crushed the protestors.

China could protect Communism b/c it learned from the Experience of USSR.

Lesson's w/c China learned from Russia!—

"Tyrannies are not in threat when they are at their worst, but when they try to Reform."

—Alex de Tocqueville.

Since, then Communist Party of China has strengthen its Position.

* ————— End of ————— *

Cold War.

* U.S. Hegemony :-

- U.S — China Relations.
- India — China Relations.
- China Challenging U.S.A's Hegemony.

Q) What is U.S.A's Grand Strategy towards China?
— Containment.

Why?

— Potential Challenger to U.S. Hegemony. In fact, bigger threat than Russia.

Why?

— B/c China is a Rimland State. The concept of Rimland State is given by Nicholas Spykman. It modifies the Theory of Mackinder.

A/c to Mackinder, World will come ultimately under the Hegemony of Continental Power / Land Power. However, Spykman held that Rimland states are at more advantageous position. Those who are the land power as well as Sea Power.

Regarding China, Napoleon once said — "When China will come out of its slumber it will astonish the world".

We can say that Napoleon was correct.

What is so special about China? -

- Never even any countries has risen so fast in all dimensions of powers like - China.

* Credentials of Chinese Powers :-

10

- a) Size
- b) Population
- c) Location
- d) Ideology
- e) The Manufacturing Centre of the World.
- f) Soft Power
- g) Leadership

In recent years, China is fast filling the Gap with U.S. in the domain of defence, modern technologies and Finance.

Q) Does this mean China does not faces Strategic Challenges?

- No, China faces more Strategic Challenges than India. Infact, the Environment for India's rise is more conducive than China's rise.

Q) How U.S.A tries to contain China? -

- By exploiting the Strategic weaknesses of China.

Q) What are Strategic imperatives of China ?-

- i) Security of its core Region.
- ii) Maintaining the internal Solidarity. It means China is not as Homogenous as generally assumed. Even its core Region is ethnically diversified, though undoubtedly dominated by Han Chinese.
- iii) Till very recently, China was not worried about protection of its coastal Region. However, since liberalisation its coastal Regions and its security has also become important concerns.
- iv) Till very recently, China didn't have too much stakes in the maritime sphere. Since, China's role in Global trade has increased its stake have increased in both :- Asia Pacific (South China Sea) as well as Indian Ocean. Hence, China has to ensure ~~its~~ the security of its Sea lines of Communications.
- v) China's Economy is export led. Hence, it is more vulnerable to the external shocks than the Indian Economy.

- There is a possibility of Internal instability in China if there is slow down in its Economic Growth. The legitimacy of the Rule of the Communist Party depends on its ability to deliver the Growth.